

HRRP Technical Meeting

Meeting Minutes

Meeting Purpose:	<i>HRRP technical Meeting</i>
Meeting Date:	<i>04/04/2017</i>
Meeting Time:	<i>2:00 pm – 4:30 pm</i>
Meeting Location:	<i>Hotel Gurkha Inn, Gorkha</i>
Meeting Facilitator:	<i>Minar Thapa Magar</i>
Minutes Taken By:	<i>Minar Thapa Magar/ Keshab Shrestha</i>

Discussion:

Chair: Mrs. Sunita Shrestha (DUDBC/DLPIU)

Guest: Mr. Rajendra Karki (NRA)

Agenda:

1. Introduction and Welcome

NRA Gorkha Chief Mr. Rajendra Karki opened the meeting with some suggestions for smooth coordination and effective reconstruction process.

- He insisted that all POs need to be open and accountable and NRA will provide continuous support from every aspect.
- Progress report and information must be shared by POs to NRA and other government line agencies regularly.

2. Dissemination (Information of process, technical information and requirements)

- HRRP district coordinator emphasized importance of dissemination of information of government plans and policies, process, technical information and overall reconstruction process to beneficiaries which will strengthen and empower community to take ownership of overall owner driven reconstruction approach.
- HRRP also requested POs to focus more on dissemination as beneficiaries are still unsure about current revised tranche disbursement process, inspection process and their role in reconstruction process.

- HHs orientation in current inspection process (HRRP/DUDBC) ([CLICK HERE](#))

- HRRP presented orientation slide prepared by NRA/CLPIU for household level orientation of inspection process.

- Information products and dissemination strategy for community orientation (CRS) ([CLICK HERE](#))

- CRS presented graphical sketch as IEC (information, education and communication) material prepared by CRS to explain current revised tranche policy, responsibilities of community in filling up application for technical support and inspection and overview of current inspection process and requested POs, DUDBC and NRA to provide feedback and suggestions to improve it.
- CRS answered that toll-free no. (free to call) mentioned in IEC tool is for Gorkha and they will also provide technical support and can send their mobile team to requester for technical support.
- DUDBC representative provided feedback that pictures are very sensitive medium to provide information and CRS should also put some required construction components in their picture.
- CRS also presented cost calculator which can be used at field level to support beneficiaries in cost estimation of their house as this tool will provide detail cost of material and labor to construct house per their selected design.
- Door to door assistance strategy and tools was shared by CRS and emphasized importance of door to door assistance at this stage of reconstruction.
- CRS announced that they will share all these tools, presentation and software with POs and government through HRRP.

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Discussion:

- Door to Door assistance and technical support team (HRRP)

- People already started reconstruction of their houses and they need technical support to construct earthquake resilience houses to get compliance with inspection checklist to receive government subsidy. Government have limited manpower and capacity and POs committed to provide technical assistance in their working VDC and HRRP requested POs to prioritize door to door assistance with technical support team.

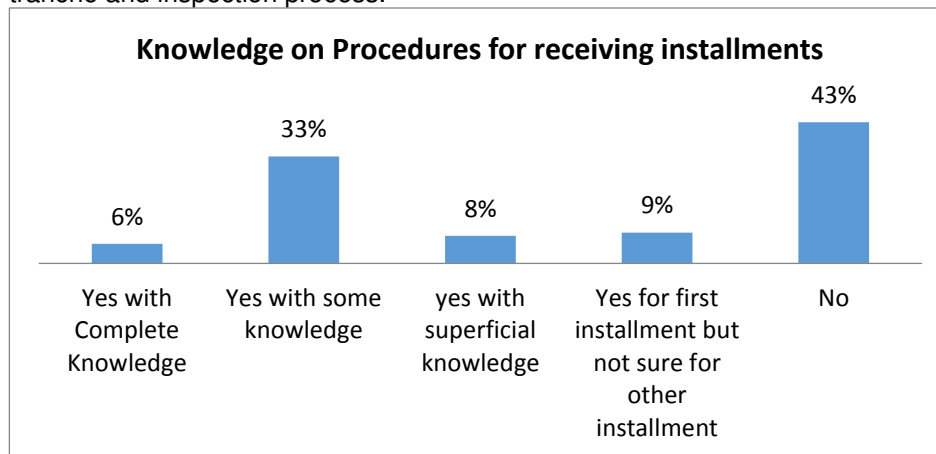
- Help desk /Technical resource center (Design support to communities)

- Current need identified in owner driven reconstruction process is house design support to communities. POs are requested to provide design support through helpdesk/Technical resource center and to increase those activities also in other areas.

3. Current Field issues (Community demand and compliance and non-compliance issues)

- Presentation from OXFAM ([Click Here](#))

- Oxfam presented assessment analysis conducted in 6 VDCs to analyze education status of head of households which says 58% never attended school and 16% with some primary education based on which communication strategy should be developed to empower effective decision making.
- Analysis also showed 52% survey HHs lives in temporary shelter and 13% have built/rebuilt their houses. Analysis also gave overview about community's knowledge in receiving tranche and inspection process.



- Many communities across the districts univocally expressed their concern about designs of the houses proposed by government that require material not available locally.
- Scarcity of water for reconstruction has also slowed the reconstruction process significantly.
- Absence of working age population from villages has posed another difficulty.
- Masons have been trained by various organizations and government in most of the working area but the number of trained masons remains insufficient.
- Some choose to leave the village for foreign employment after receiving the training.
- Lack of information about government policies, shortage of technical information and technicians to provide information for reconstruction as per government norms has made it difficult to follow the policies.

- Update from JICA

- JICA updated that draft correction manual for housing reconstruction has already been drafted and now shared with all DLPIU to get feedback and suggestions from DLPIU field engineers as they are exposed to many challenges and even they can suggest best practices followed locally.

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- Presentation from CRS

- CRS presented some of the non-complaint issues from field where communities are coming with new hybrid technology which may be stronger than approved design and sometimes more safe than minimum requirements in building code.
- DUDBC/DLPIU briefed that those types of structure should be reported through different form Annex-17 for mixed/hybrid and new technology building and till now not even single house has been registered in that form.
- People are requesting technical assistance and support in correcting their current construction if they don't comply with minimum requirements for example some people already constructed RC frame structure where they use 6 rebar of size 2 of 16 dia and 4 of 12 dia and they already constructed till plinth level now they want to correct it to get compliance but there is no fixed suggestion for that case.

4 6 new NRA approved low cost housing designs (DUDBC/HRRP) and DUDBC Design catalogue-II

- HRRP presented new recently released volume two of DUDBC Catalogue for alternative construction materials and technology. HRRP also committed to share it and 6 new approved low cost housing designs with POs.

PARKING LOT:

- 1. Timber management and potential support from partners(DFO)*
- 2. Support from POs field based technical staff in providing feedback and suggestions for correction manual. (DUDBC/DLPIU)*

Miscellaneous Items / AOB:

- 1. Coordination and cooperation between DLPIU and PO staff in their working VDCs*
 - HRRP highlighted importance of coordination and cooperation between field level DLPIU and POs engineer as POs are also providing technical assistance and supporting inspection process and both side should be in same page with same level of understanding for achieving common objective.
 - HRRP requested POs to involve government engineers in VDC level program and to make strategy to develop strong harmonization to work as team.
- 2. VDC/Ward level coordination meeting between PO staff, DLPIU staff, MOFALD staff etc. in regular basis.*
- 3. Regular information sharing mechanism between Ward/VDC level and at district level.*

Conclusion Made: Mrs. Sunita Shrestha (DUDBC/DLPIU)

- 1. Uniformity must be maintained in dissemination strategy and products with coordination as we jointly decided in previous one day technical workshop.*
- 2. Communication strategy should be determined based on HHs literacy rate and various visual and audio communication mediums should be prioritize.*
 - *Radio Jingle/Television awareness (visual media), toll free no. etc.*
- 3. POs field based technical staff are requested to provide suggestions and feedback in draft version of correction manual which will be shared by DLPIU to HRRP.*
- 4. POs are requested to share and adopt IEC materials, cost calculator, door to door assistance tools if relevant in their technical assistance strategy.*

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Attendees	Organisation	Phone No.	Email
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